MIL-D-50865A (PA)
29 March 1976
SUPERSEDING
MIL-D-50865 (MU)
16 March 1971

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

DETONATOR, STAB, M59

LOADING, ASSEMBLING AND PACKING

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers the loading, assembling and packing for one type of detonator designated as Detonator, Stab, M59.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-A-48078	- Ammunition, Standard Quality Assurance Provisions, General Specification For
MIL-M-14077	- Molded Plastic, Polyetrofluoroethylene (TFE - Fluorocarbin Resin)

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

FSC: 1375

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DRAWINGS

PICATINNY ARSENAL

PRODUCT AND PACKING DRAWINGS

8857254	- Detonator, Stab, M59
9258182	- Box, Setup, Packing, Ammunition, Inner for Small Explosive
9258183	- Box, Setup, Packing, Ammunition, Outer for Small Explosive Components
9258184	- Box, Packing, Ammunition, for Small Explosive Components

INSPECTION EQUIPMENT DRAWINGS

7304802	- Indicator
8827892	- Holder
8802085	- Fixture Testing
8841061	- Assembly
8827829	- Bushing
8827893	- Holder, Firing Pin
8827863	- Sleeve
8827894	- Firing Pin
8827871	- Adapter, Ball
9202650	- Disc, Steel
9266380	- Disc, Lead

2.2 Other Publications - The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

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CODE OF FEDERAL REGULATIONS

TITLE 49 - Transportation, Parts 100-199

(The Code of Federal Regulations is available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402. Orders should specify, "49 CFR 100-199 (latest revision)").

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material - Materials shall be in accordance with the applicable drawings and specifications.

3.2 Loading - Loading shall comply with all requirements specified on Drawing (Dwg.) 8857254, all associated drawings, and with all requirements specified in applicable specifications.

3.3 Moisture Content -

3.3.1 Lead Azide - The moisture content of the lead azide at the loading station at the time of loading the detonators shall not exceed 0.50 percent.

3.3.2 Primer Mixture - The moisture content of the primer mixture at the loading station at the time of loading the detonator shall not exceed 0.30 percent.

3.4 Functioning -

3.4.1 Sensitivity and Energy Output - The detonators shall function satisfactorily as evidenced by a depression in the lead block of a minimum depth of 1/4 inch or as evidenced by a depression in the steel disc of a minimum depth of .020.

3.4.2 Waterproofness - The detonators shall be waterproof as evidenced by functioning after water immersion.

3.5 Workmanship - All parts and assemblies shall be fabricated, loaded and assembled in a thorough, workmanlike manner. They shall be free of burrs, sharp edges, cracks, dirt, grease, rust and other foreign matter. The cleaning method used shall not be injurious to any part, nor shall the parts be contaminated by the cleaning agents. Exterior surface coatings shall be continuous except for a few light scratches not exposing base material. All required marking and stamping shall be neat and sharply defined.

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3.6 First Article Inspection - This specification contains technical provisions for first article inspection. Requirements for the submission of first article samples by the contractor shall be as specified in the contract.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for Inspection and Standard Quality Assurance Provisions - Unless otherwise specified herein or in the contract, the provisions of MIL-A-48078 shall apply and are hereby made a part of this detail specification.

4.2 Classification of Inspections - The following types of inspection shall be conducted on this item:

a. First Article Inspection
b. Quality Conformance Inspection

4.3 First Article Inspection

4.3.1 Submission - The contractor shall submit a first article as designated by the Contracting Officer for evaluation in accordance with the provisions of 4.3.2. The first article sample shall consist of the following items in sample quantities as indicated.

Part Description	Drawings	Quantity
Detonator, Stab, M59	8857254	365

4.3.2 Inspections to be Performed - See MIL-A-48078 and Table 1 herein.

4.3.3 Rejection - See MIL-A-48078 and Table 1.

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TABLE 1 - FIRST ARTICLE INSPECTION
CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER
	Detonator, Stab, M59				See Below
					NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
	Detonator (Dwg. 8857254)				
	Examination for Defects	365	-	3.2	4.4.2.2
	Sensitivity and Energy Output	315	0.40%	3.4.1	4.5.3
	Waterproofness	50	4.00%	3.4.2	4.5.4

NOTES:

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4.4 Quality Conformance Inspection

4.4.1 Inspection Lot Formation - Inspection lots shall comply with the lot formation provisions of MIL-A-48078. In addition, each inspection lot shall contain:

a. Metal parts of one interfix lot number from one manufacturer.
b. Primer mixture consisting of batches blended by the same process. Each batch shall be composed of the same ingredients, each of which is to be from one interfix lot from one manufacturer.
c. Lead azide from one interfix lot number from one manufacturer.
d. RDX pellets of one interfix lot number from one manufacturer.

4.4.2 Examination - See MIL-A-48078.

a. Sampling Plans - Unless otherwise specified in the Classification of Defects and Test Tables, sampling plans for major and minor defects shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Inspection Level II.

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QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

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PARAGRAPH	TITLE	SHEET 1 OF 1	DRAWING NUMBER
4.4.2.1	Assembly, prior to loading		8857254
			NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY

CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
Critical					
1	Cup cut, split or cracked		100%	3.2	Visual
Major					
101	Moisture content of lead azide	6 grams	-	3.3.1	4.5.1
102	Moisture content of primer mixture	6 grams	-	3.3.2	4.5.2
Minor					
201	Evidence of poor workmanship		0.65%	3.5	Visual

NOTES:

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QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-D-50865A (PA)

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER
4.4.2.2	Assembly				8857254
					NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
Critical					
1	Caked explosive on exterior		100%	3.2	Visual
2	Explosive exposed		100%	3.2	Visual
Major					
101	Total length, max.		0.40%	3.2	7304802-8872892
102	Outside diameter		0.40%	3.2	7304802-8872892
103	Paint on wrong end or paint on both ends or no paint		0.40%	3.2	Visual
104	Sensitivity and energy output	4.4.3	-	3.4.1	8802895 8827894 8841061 8827871 8827829 9202650 8827893 9266380 8827863 4.5.3
105	Waterproofness	50	4.00%	3.4.2	4.5.4
Minor					
201	Distortion		0.65%	3.2	Visual
202	Disc wrinkled or folded		0.65%	3.2	Visual
203	Crimp not full 360 degrees		0.65%	3.2	Visual
204	Evidence of poor workmanship		0.65%	3.2	Visual

NOTES:

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4.4.3 Testing -

4.4.3.1 Functioning -

4.4.3.1.1 Sensitivity and Energy Output - Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Normal Inspection, Table III-A, using a sampling size code letter P and an AQL of 0.40%. The provisions of Para 8 of MIL-STD-105, regarding reduced or tightened inspection shall apply.

4.4.3.1.2 After ten (10) successive lots have complied with 4.4.3.1.1, the following may be used:

Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Normal Inspection Table III-A, using a sampling size Code Letter P and an AQL of 0.46 Percent. The provisions of Para 8 of MIL-STD-105, regarding reduced or tightened inspection shall apply. Testing shall be as specified in 4.5.3. If a lot is rejected during this test, the contractor may continue, using this test for the next nine (9) consecutive lots. If all nine (9) consecutive lots meet the acceptance criteria, then this test may remain in effect; however, if any of the nine (9) consecutive lots are rejected, the contractor shall revert back to the test specified in 4.4.3.1.1. In addition, if there is a change in process or source of raw ingredients, the contractor shall revert back to the test specified in 4.4.3.1.1. After ten (1) consecutive lots have again complied with the criteria specified in 4.4.3.1.1, then the test specified herein may be resumed.

4.4.4 Inspection Equipment - The inspection equipment required to perform the examinations and tests prescribed herein is described in the Paragraph Reference/Inspection Method column in the tables starting with Paragraph 4.4.2.1. The contractor shall submit for approval inspection equipment designs in accordance with the terms of the contract. See Section 6 of MIL-A-48078 and 6.3 herein.

4.5 Test Methods and Procedures -

4.5.1 Determination of Moisture Contents of Lead Azide - A tared dried aluminum dish 2 inches in diameter shall be covered with a sheet of teflon (See Specification MIL-M-14077) 2 1/2 inches square and sufficiently flat to form a tight cover. An accurately weighed portion of approximately two grams shall be transferred to the moisture dish while both the cover and

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dish are on the balance pan. The dish and contents shall be transferred to an oven and dried at 95C. plus or minus (± 2°C for 2 hours. The cover shall be placed in a sulfuric acid desiccator during the drying period. After drying, the dish shall be quickly transferred to the desiccator and allowed to cool to room temperature. The teflon cover shall be placed on the dish and the assembly weighed. The loss in weight shall be calculated to percentage of moisture in the lead azide as follows:

$$\text{Percentage of Moisture} = \frac{A-B \times 100}{A}$$

Where:

A = the weight of the specimen before drying.
B = the weight of the specimen after drying.

4.5.2 Test of Primer Mixture -

4.5.2.1 Moisture Content - Transfer an accurately weighed portion of approximately one gram of the primer mixture to a tared aluminum weighing dish provided with a teflon cover while both the dish and cover are on the balance pan. Place the dish and contents with the cover removed in an oven maintained at 60° ± 5°C for 2 hours. The cover shall be placed in a desiccator during the drying period. After drying, transfer the dish and contents quickly to a desiccator and cool in room temperature. Replace the plastic cover and weigh. Calculate the loss in weight of the dish cover and contents to percent moisture in the sample.

4.5.2.2 Composition - The analysis of the composition shall be performed as follows:

4.5.2.2.1 Barium Nitrate - Transfer an accurately weighed portion of approximately 0.5 gram of the dried sample (dried as described in 4.5.2.1) to a tared medium porosity fritted glass crucible of 30 milliliter (ml.) capacity. Record the weight of crucible and sample as Weight A. Add 3 ml. of distilled water saturated with lead azide at a temperature of 5° + 2°C. Swirl for 30 seconds, then apply suction. Repeat this procedure two times, making a total of three (3) ml. extractions. Using an eye dropper, transfer to the crucible enough alcohol to thoroughly wet the sample and wash the crucible walls. Aspirate until the

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odor of alcohol is no longer detectable and dry the crucible in an oven for 30 minutes at 60 ° + 5°C. Cool in a desiccator and weigh. Record this weight as Weight B. Reserve the crucible and residue for the normal or basic lead styphnate determination. Correct for the percentage of normal or basic lead styphnate in the water extract as follows: Transfer the filtrate and washings quantitively to a 100 ml. calibrated volumetric flash, washing the beaker thoroughly with distilled water and dilute to the mark. Using a calibrated pipette, transfer a 10 ml. aliquet of this solution to a second 100 ml. calibrated polumetric flash and dilute to the mark with distilled water. Transfer a portion of this solution to a corex glass spectrophotometric cell (See 6.3) having a width of approximately 1 centimeter (cm) and determine its optical density at a wave length of 410 millimicrons. Use as reference a similar cell containing the same proportion of water saturated with lead azide and alcohol as the sample solution. Since the cell which holds the lead styphnate solution is not identical with the reference cell, correct the optical density obtained as described above for the difference in the amount of light which the two cells scatter and absorb. To do this, fill both cells with a solution of water and alcohol, and measure at a wave length of 410 millimicrons, the optical density of the cell which orignally contained the normal lead styphnate solution. Calculate the percentage of normal lead styphnate in the filtrate on a dry basis as follows:

Normal lead styphnate found in barium nitrate filtrate, Percent $P_n = \frac{2.94\ (A-B)}{WD}$

Basic lead styphnate found in barium nitrate filtrate, Percent $Pb = \frac{4.48\ (A-B)}{WD}$

Where:

A = Optical density of normal lead styphnate solution.
B = Optical density of water and alcohol solution.
D = Width of corex cell, cm.
W = Weight of dried sample.

Calculate the percentage of barium nitrate in the sample as follows:

Barium nitrate, percent $= \frac{100\ (A-B)}{W} - (P_b \text{ or } P_n)$

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Where:

W = Weight of the dried sample.
A = Weight of crucible and sample.
B = Weight of the crucible and sample after extractions with water saturated with lead azide.
P_n = Percentage of normal lead styphnate found in barium nitrate filtrate.
P_b = Percentage of basic lead styphnate found in barium nitrate filtrate.

4.5.2.2.2 Basic or Normal Lead Styphnate - The residue obtained in the determination of barium nitrate shall be extracted with six-ml portions of ammonium acetate solution at about 25C, (hot ammonium acetate shall not be used as it dissolves antimony sulfide to some extent) agitating each portion for about 30 seconds and allowing each portion to remain in contract with the residue for approximately 2 minutes. The residue shall be washed with water, saturated with antimony sulfide, until the washing coming through the crucible appears colorless. The filtrate and washings shall be quantitatively transferred to a 250-ml calibrated volumetric flask, the beaker washed thoroughly with distilled water and diluted to the mark. Using a calibrated pipette, a 2-ml aliquot of this solution shall be transferred to a 50-ml calibrated volumetric flask in the case of basic lead styphnate, or a 2-ml aliquot of the solution shall be transferred to a 100-ml calibrated volumetric flask in the case of normal lead styphnate and diluted to the mark with distilled water. A portion of this solution shall be transferred to a corex glass spectophotometric cell having a width of approximately one centimeter (cm) and its optical density determined at a wave length of 410 millimicrons. As a reference, a similar cell containing ammonium acetate solution of the same concentration as the solution of the specimen shall be used. Since the cell which holds the basic lead styphnate is not identical with the reference cell, the optical density obtained shall be corrected as described above for the difference in the amount of light which the two cells scatter and absorb. This shall be done by filling both cells with ammonium acetate solution and measuring at a wave length of 410 millimicrons, the optical density of the cell which originally contained the lead styphnate solution. The percentage of normal or basic lead styphnate in the specimen shall be calculated as follows:

$$\text{Percentage basic lead styphnate} = \frac{28\ (A-B)}{WD} \pm P_b$$

$$\text{Percentage normal lead styphnate} = \frac{36.75\ (A-B)}{WD} \pm P_n$$

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Where:

A = Optical density of normal or basic lead styphnate.
B = Optical density of ammonium acetate solution.
C = Width of corex cell, cm.
W = Weight of dried specimen.
P_b = Percent basic lead styphnate found in barium nitrate filtrate.
P_n = Percent normal lead styphnate found in barium nitrate filtrate.

4.5.2.2.3 - Tetracene - The wet residue obtained in the determination of basic lead styphnate shall be washed three times with alcohol, dried in an oven maintained at 60 ± 5 C, for 30 minutes, cooled in a desiccator and weighed. The dried residue in the crucible shall be transferred to a 125-ml beaker with a stream of water, 25-ml of water shall be added, and the contents of the beaker boiled on a hot plate for 5 minutes. The contents of the beaker shall be poured into the same crucible and the residue in the crucible washed three times with boiling water and finally with alcohol. The crucible and contents shall be dried in an oven maintained at 60 ± 5 C for 30 minutes, cooled in a desiccator and weighed. The percentage of tetracene in the specimen shall be calculated as follows:

$$\text{Tetracene, percent} = \frac{(C-D)\ 100}{W}$$

Where:

C = Weight of crucible and residue after extraction with saturated ammonium acetate solution.
D = Weight of crucible and residue after treating with hot water.
W = Weight of the dried specimen.

4.5.2.2.4 Antimony Sulfide - The weight of the residue will be calculated from the determination of tetracene to percentage antimony sulfide in the specimen as follows:

$$\text{Antimony sulfide, percent} = \frac{(D-E)\ 100}{W}$$

Where:

D = Weight of crucible and specimen after treating with hot water.
E = Weight of crucible.
W = Weight of dried specimen.

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4.5.2.2.5 Lead Azide - The lead azide content in the specimen shall be determined by subtracting from 100 the combined percentage of barium nitrate, basic or normal lead styphnate, tetracene and antimony sulfide.

4.5.3 Functioning -

4.5.3.1 Sensitivity and Energy Output - The detonator assemblies shall be mounted in test fixture. A weight of 0.25 ± 0.01 ounce shall be dropped from a height of four (4) inches on the firing pin. Satisfactory functioning, when measured, shall be evidenced by the size of depression in the lead block.

4.5.3.2 Sensitivity and Energy Output - The detonator assemblies shall be mounted in test fixture. A weight of 0.25 ± 0.01 ounce shall be dropped from a height of four (4) inches on the firing pin. Satisfactory functioning, when measured. shall be evidenced by the size of depression in the steel disc. The steel disc used in this test shall be of the hardness specified on the steel disc drawing.

4.5.4 Waterproofness - The detonators shall be immersed in water to a depth of not less than two inches but not more than three inches for a period of 48 hours, minimum. Both the water and the detonators shall be within the temperature range of 60° to 80° Fahrenheit (F) throughout the test. Within one hour after removal from the water, the detonators shall be tested according to the test procedure for functioning (See 4.5.3.1 or 4.5.3.2).

4.5.5 Check Test for Deterioration of Detonators (not applicable to new production) - If the toal elapsed time between the original acceptance of the detonator lot and the assembly of that lot into the ammunition component with which it is to be issued exceeds two years, or if the detonators have been subjected to adverse conditions for any length of time since previous tests, the detonator lot shall be subjected to and shall satisfactorily pass the functioning tests specified in 4.5.3. The sampling plan for this test shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 using Code Letter N and AQL of 0.65 percent. The tests shall be conducted at Government expense (See 6.6) without cost to the contractor loading the detonator or the contractor assembling the detonator into the item for which it is issued, and shall not constitute a basis for rejection against either contractor except where deterioration has occurred as a direct result of carelessness in handling or storage permitted by either contractor while the lot is under such contractor's jurisdiction.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation and Packaging -

5.1.1 Level A - The detonators shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with Dwgs 9258182, 9258183 and 9258184.

5.2 Packing -

5.2.1 Level A - The detonators, preserved and packaged as specified in 5.1.1, shall be packed in accordance with Dwgs 9258182, 9258183 and 9258184.

5.3 Marking - Marking shall be in accordance with Dwgs 9258182, 9258183 and 9258184 and Code of Federal Regulations, Title 49, Parts 100-199.

5.4 Shipping - When components from more than one lot are shipped as a carload, each lot shall be kept separate and the division between lots clearly indicated to prevent mixing of the lots in transit.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended Use - The component covered by this specification is intended for use with various fuzes.

6.2 Ordering Data - See MIL-A-48078.

6.3 Submission of Inspection Equipment Designs for Approval - See MIL-A-48078. Submit equipment designs as required to Commander, Attn: SARPA-QA-T, Picatinny Arsenal, Dover, NJ 07801.

6.4 Submission of Results of Contractor-conducted Examinations - Data shall be submitted in accordance with data item DI-R-1721 on the DD Form 1423 for the contract.

6.5 Submission of Test Data - In addition to the normal distribution of records, when the detonator is procured by the US Army Armament Command, one (1) copy of all ballistic data and ammunition data cards shall be forwarded to Commander, Picatinny Arsenal, Attn: SARPA-QA-A-S.

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6.6 Check Test for Possible Deterioration - The following test is designed to prevent detonators that have deteriorated from being assembled into major ammunition items. The test shall be performed on detonators from each lot which have been stored for more than two years or under adverse conditions for any period of time. If the specification for the ammunition item into which the detonators are assembled does not require that the check test be performed, the contracting officer should insert in the contract a provision for the performance of the check test. The contractor officer will arrange for the contractor to be reimbursed for expense incurred in his performance of the check test for possible deterioration.

6.6.1 Functioning Sensitivity and Energy Output - The sampling plan for the test shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Normal Inspection, Table III-A using a sampling size code letter N and an AQL of 0.65%. The test shall be performed as specified in 4.5.3.

Custodian:
Army-PA

Preparing Activity:
Army-PA

Project Number: 1375-A164

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MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

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